The warm-up filters, explained

Warm-up on SendKit is not a fixed volume schedule. It runs on a real health score, and two filters help you manage the traffic it generates: a header code that separates warm-up emails from real replies, and a mailbox-list status that flags warm-up that is not behaving. Here is what each one does, when it matters, and how to troubleshoot a stalled warm-up.

The health score behind it all

A new mailbox sends just 3 to 4 warm-up emails on day one, then volume rises as the health score climbs, up to around 25 emails a day for Google mailboxes and 20 to 25 for Microsoft. Warm-up runs every day, including weekends, because inbox providers do not pause on weekends. The score reflects real signals: whether warm-up emails land in the inbox or spam, and how they get treated once they arrive. It is not a countdown timer, which is why it climbs slowly instead of jumping to a flattering number on day one.

Filter 1: the warm-up header code

Every warm-up email carries a unique identifying code in its message headers. It is invisible in the email body, and it exists for exactly one purpose: telling warm-up traffic apart from real replies programmatically.

When it matters: if you are an agency forwarding client replies out of SendKit inboxes, warm-up traffic lives in the same mailbox and will get swept into the forward unless you filter it out.

How to use it: build your forwarding or inbox rule to check the headers for the warm-up code and exclude any matching message. Gmail rules, Outlook rules, or whatever system already sits between your mailbox and the client all support filtering on header values, so no separate tool is needed. Because the identifier lives in the headers rather than the subject or body, the rule stays reliable even as warm-up copy changes. It is a one-time setup, not something you maintain by hand.

Filter 2: "warm-up needing attention"

In your mailbox list, filter for the **warm-up needing attention** status. This flag means a mailbox's warm-up is not behaving as expected: its warm-up sends have dropped off, its reply pattern looks off, or its health score has stalled instead of climbing.

It is not a single failure state and not a diagnosis on its own. Treat it as a prompt to run the troubleshooting checks below on that mailbox rather than assuming warm-up is quietly running in the background.

Warm-up looks stalled? Troubleshoot in this order

1. **Check for a mailbox disconnect.** The most common cause: an expired token, a changed password, or a revoked app permission on the provider side. A disconnected mailbox has nothing to send through. Reconnect first, then recheck.
2. **Run the "warm-up needing attention" filter.** Any mailbox showing the flag deserves a closer look before you assume warm-up is fine.
3. **Check for inbound warm-up replies.** A healthy warm-up shows inbound replies landing in the mailbox, warm-up mailboxes replying to each other as part of the normal exchange. No warm-up reply traffic at all is the stronger signal that warm-up has actually stopped rather than just slowed down.

READINESS RULES WORTH MEMORIZING

- A mailbox is ready for cold sending at a **96% health score and at least 14 days** of warm-up. Both conditions matter; neither alone is enough.
- **Warm-up never stops.** It keeps running alongside live campaigns to reinforce reputation. Turning it off while a mailbox is still sending cold email is the fastest way to see health scores slide.
- Because SendKit tracks a real score and reply activity per mailbox, a stalled warm-up shows up as a visible flag instead of a mailbox quietly losing reputation until campaign results suffer.

Five minutes in the mailbox list tells you where every mailbox stands: filter for warm-up needing attention, confirm connections, and confirm inbound warm-up replies are flowing.

Check your warm-up health →